

Rahul Sharma

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1 Project Objectives

The goal of this project is to develop a comprehensive Ethics and Sustainability Policy for SHOT Café. It is a UAE-based food and beverage organisation which relies on digital platforms for customer satisfaction and service delivery. Nowadays, technology has made organisations increasingly dependent on data-driven systems. More and more businesses tend to collect, analyse and use data from their operations for their benefits. Hence, the ethical handling of information of customers has become a primary concern.

The aim of this project is to identify and analyse the ethical concerns regarding data collection, storage and usage withing SHOT Café's digital ecosystem. This includes its website, third-party platforms, and social media channels as well. Furthermore, it seeks to evaluate stakeholder roles, legal compliance requirements, and sustainability considerations associated with information systems.

The ultimate goal is to put forth a methodical and workable policy framework that complies with pertinent legal and ethical requirements, guarantees responsible data management, encourages transparency, and supports long-term sustainability.

2 Introduction

Modern businesses are rapidly transforming digitally and as a result there has been a significant growth in reliance on data-driven systems. This is particularly seen in businesses which are customer-oriented such as food and beverage services. Organizations collect, process and analyse customer data through their websites, mobile applications and other third-party platforms to enhance the operational efficiency and customer experience. This increasing reliance on data and dependence on digital technologies has raised serious concerns related to data privacy, transparency and ethical information management (Spiekermann et al., 2022).

SHOT Specialty Café is a UAE-based coffee brand which uses social media and internet ordering platforms and third-party delivery services to operate its business from physical locations and digital platforms throughout the United Arab Emirates. The system collects customer data which includes contact details, transaction history, and user behaviour information during their online interactions. Whenever users order something, they must sign-in which gives data to the platform. The data-driven methods of service delivery create better

service results through improved service customization but these methods also create ethical issues which involve data misuse and lack of system transparency and unauthorized data sharing with third parties (Biega et al., 2020).

The situation requires organizations to establish effective data governance systems and ethical information systems. The establishment of proper governance systems protects user privacy which builds trust while ensuring that data quality and accountability and legal compliance requirements are maintained (Cheong & Chang, 2007). Therefore, this project evaluates SHOT Café's data practices and aims to develop a structured ethics and sustainability policy to address these challenges. In modern tech-business world, the reliance on third-party digital ecosystems is increasing rapidly. This also creates a "diffusion of responsibility." Here, the accountability of data protection and ethical use is fragmented across multiple stakeholders and actors. Thus, ensuring ethical use of data becomes much more important.

3 Company Overview

With a significant presence in Abu Dhabi, SHOT Specialty Café is a domestic coffee brand located in the United Arab Emirates that operates in the food and beverage retail industry. A group of coffee enthusiasts established this company as a specialty coffee concept. The aim was to deliver high-quality coffee experiences rooted in the "third-wave coffee" movement (Shot Specialty Café, 2022). The company was initially a mobile coffee truck. Soon enough, the brand expanded across the UAE and currently it has grown into one of the most prominent specialty coffee chains in Abu Dhabi.

The company operates from various physical branches. It also leverages digital platforms like its website, online ordering system and other third-party digital services. Customers can browse menus, place orders and interact with the brand digitally with the help of such services and platforms. During the operations, SHOT Café takes various forms of customer data which also includes the personal information of the customers like their names and contact details. Other data collected are transactional data and behavioural data which relates to the customer preferences and ordering patterns. Since data is collected via multiple platforms, this creates a "data aggregation risk." A risk of generating more sensitive insights than originally intended is formed.

The organization needs ethical data management procedures because its digital technology operations have increased their dependency on data. The process of handling customer data needs to operate effectively because it serves two purposes: first, it maintains user trust and data security, and second, it meets regulatory standards. The operational activities of SHOT Café depend on ethical data governance because it determines their capacity to conduct business and sustain their operations.

4 Ethical Issues Identification

SHOT Café now uses multiple digital platforms to support its daily operations. The system includes three components which are the website, delivery application and social media channels. The system now enables customer data to be collected and processed through multiple customer interaction points. The systems improve operational efficiency while increasing customer interactions but they create significant ethical problems. The problems involve three main areas which are transparency requirements and security protections and responsible data management.

4.1 Data Collection

The SHOT Café data collection system needs to improve its transparency and informed consent process. Organizations must provide complete information about their data collection methods and data usage policies and their data access authorization according to ethical guidelines. Users cannot make informed choices about their personal data according to unidentified functional privacy policy (Fernández et al., 2020). The data minimization principle states that organizations must only collect data needed to achieve their specific objectives. The research shows that people will create more serious privacy problems because the system collects unnecessary data which includes their online behavior across multiple sites (Biega et al., 2020). The limited data disclosure practices of SHOT Café create a situation where operational efficiency conflicts with ethical standards which leads to decreased consumer trust and regulatory issues.

4.2 Data Storage

The data management and storage methods used by SHOT Café create ethical dilemmas which need to be resolved. Digital systems store personal information which creates a need for strong security because these systems face increased risks of data breaches and unauthorized access

(Masciari et al., 2024). Organizations face uncertainty about how long they will store customer data because their data retention practices remain inadequately defined (Fernández et al., 2020). Organizations need to establish clear accountability systems because their data governance programs require executives to oversee data security operations together with their IT security duties (Cheong & Chang, 2007). The combination of weak data governance systems and inconsistent data management methods brings both compliance risks and ethical challenges.

4.3 Data Usage

The SHOT Café digital space creates extra ethical problems because it handles customer data to make choices based on data and share information with outside organizations. Customers will experience privacy violations because their data gets processed by external platforms which include delivery services that share their information without informing them. The procedures used by the company break ethical standards which require businesses to preserve customer rights during data collection processes (Bose, 2012). AI-based systems which companies use for personalization and recommendation purposes create three primary issues which companies must address because they affect customer profiling and system biases and customer behavior manipulation. Users find it challenging to comprehend or contest decisions that impact them since these systems frequently function with little transparency (Masciari et al., 2024). The company operates its business by using methods which restrict user choice while determining business results which will create permanent changes to who takes responsibility and what is fair and how people trust each other.

4.4 Summary

Overall, problems with openness, data security, and responsible use are reflected in the ethical concerns found in SHOT Café's data practices. Resolving these issues is crucial for maintaining ethical and sustainable company practices, building consumer confidence, and complying with regulations.

5 Policy Scope

The initial boundaries of SHOT Café's ethical policy development create a system, which handles data management responsibilities while maintaining compliance with ethical business standards and legal requirements. This document establishes its main purpose of creating transparent data handling procedures, which enable customers to comprehend their data

processing methods, thus establishing trust in the system (Fernández et al., 2020). The policy protects user privacy rights through secure personal data processing, which occurs only for valid business purposes, thus demonstrating organizational dedication to safeguarding stakeholder rights (Bose, 2012).

The policy follows its objectives through implementation of essential ethical standards. The organization needs to treat all stakeholders fairly through its data handling procedures because this practice serves to protect their rights. The organization needs to establish accountability as its main operational system because its leaders must guarantee responsible data protection through their organization rather than depending on technology (Cheong & Chang, 2007). Data minimization and informed consent principles enable organizations to collect only essential user data while users maintain authority over their data usage (Biega et al., 2020; Fernández et al., 2020).

The policy control extends to SHOT Café because it establishes transparent governance systems which the organization must implement. The procedure requires organizations to establish data management responsibilities, while organizations must align their decision-making processes according to ethical standards and business needs. The organization uses good governance practices to achieve standardized operation methods which decrease data processing uncertainties and create ethical behavior standards within the organization (Cheong & Chang, 2007).

The policy establishes its focus on essential business operations which include all aspects of data handling, from collection through storage to usage. The regulation needs to establish detailed guidelines which will manage all aspects of data collection, storage processes, and third-party data sharing activities. Organizations must establish monitoring systems, which will ensure all data-related activities adhere to established ethical standards and can undergo verification when required (Fernández et al., 2020). The policy establishes a framework for moral, open, and long-term data handling at SHOT Café using this methodical methodology.

6 Alignment with Legal and Regulatory Framework

The ethical data practices of SHOT Café must align with established legal and regulatory frameworks governing data protection in the United Arab Emirates. The main legal framework for managing personal data is provided by the UAE Personal Data Protection Law (PDPL)

(Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021), which establishes principles of accountability and transparency and approved methods of handling personal data. According to the framework, businesses must only gather and handle personal data when they have a legitimate legal justification, which includes getting user consent. The rules comply with existing data protection regulations, which require businesses to obtain user permission before they start processing personal data.

Organizations must implement responsible data governance according to regulatory requirements established by entities such as the UAE Data Office. The organization must follow purpose limitation and data minimization principles because these principles restrict data collection to necessary information that must be used to achieve specific goals (Biega et al., 2020). SHOT Café requirements need the business to create documented procedures which regulate how customer data is collected and subsequently stored and shared through digital channels.

Organizations need to demonstrate complete commitment to their operational duties to maintain compliance with legal obligations. Effective data governance frameworks need to be developed which enable management and decision-makers to take responsibility for data protection tasks that extend beyond technical system protection (Cheong & Chang, 2007). Companies must establish internal monitoring systems which operate continuously to verify their data practices maintain compliance with user consent requirements and regulatory standards (Fernández et al., 2020).

The organization will face severe consequences from legal violations which include financial penalties and damage to its reputation and loss of customer trust. SHOT Café needs to follow legal requirements but it should also implement ethical principles which include fairness and accountability and privacy protection into all aspects of its operations. Organizations need to establish a dual system of ethical and regulatory data governance because legal compliance will not meet stakeholder expectations according to their current organizational practices (Bose, 2012).

7 Stakeholders and Ethical Responsibilities

The SHOT Café digital system requires multiple stakeholders to manage its data operations effectively throughout its digital system. The stakeholders maintain separate roles and

obligations while their personal interests create major effects on the ethical outcomes. The stakeholders divide into two main categories which include internal and external groups. The internal stakeholder group consists of management personnel together with IT staff and all data operators who take part in decision-making. External stakeholders include customers together with delivery platforms and other external service providers. All actors who handle data as producers, processors or users need to take part in information systems operations because their actions define ethical data handling methods (Cheong & Chang, 2007).

The SHOT Café divides its responsibilities between two main areas which include organizational work and technical work. The management team establishes data policies which they use to ensure that their organization operates according to both legal requirements and ethical standards while IT staff members create secure data storage systems that protect organizational information (Owen & Drake, 2023). At the organizational level, management holds primary responsibility for establishing data policies and ensuring alignment with legal and ethical standards (Cheong & Chang, 2007). System developers and platform operators create digital systems which require them to implement ethical standards because their design choices determine data handling practices (Spiekermann et al., 2022). The organization requires all employees to take on ethical duties because this responsibility extends beyond any specific department.

The stakeholders have an ethical responsibility to protect user data while ensuring that their data handling methods maintain privacy, fairness, and transparent operations. Organizations must protect personal information through ethical data practices which respect stakeholder rights while avoiding dangerous and deceptive practices (Bose, 2012). Customers rely on SHOT Café's digital platforms to safely manage their personal information so maintaining confidence is very crucial. Organizations need to implement accountability systems together with governance frameworks to ensure their members act responsibly throughout all operational areas.

The presence of multiple parties creates fundamental conflicts which develop into essential tensions throughout their interactions. The need to protect user rights creates a vital conflict which companies face when they attempt to collect customer information for their business objectives while protecting user privacy (Bose, 2012). Data-driven systems which prioritize performance achievement above fairness and transparency create situations which force

organizations to choose between operational efficiency and their commitment to ethical obligations (Spiekermann et al., 2022). SHOT Café needs to establish ethical standards and governance frameworks which will help them address their current competing interests.

The stakeholders play an essential role in determining how SHOT Café manages its data according to ethical standards. The system requires understanding their responsibilities because this knowledge helps to manage conflicts in order to establish fair, transparent and accountable information system operations.

Stakeholder	Category	Role in Data / IS	Ethical Responsibility	Key Ethical Concern
SHOT Café Customers	End Users	Provide personal data (name, phone, address, payment info) when placing orders via shot.ae, Talabat, or Foodics.	Have the right to informed consent, data access, correction, and deletion under UAE PDPL.	Lack of a functional privacy policy on shot.ae means customers cannot make informed decisions about their data.
Website & Platform Developers	Developers	Build and maintain shot.ae and integrate third-party systems like Foodics. Their design choices directly determine how data is collected and stored.	Must implement privacy-by-design principles, ensuring systems collect only necessary data and protect it by default.	A broken privacy policy page on shot.ae suggests insufficient attention to ethical system design.
SHOT Café Management	Managers	Make strategic decisions on which digital platforms to use, what data to collect, and how it is governed internally.	Primarily accountable for establishing and enforcing data governance policies across the organization.	Without a formal data governance framework, management decisions on data use may be inconsistent or non-compliant.
Talabat & Foodics	Vendors / Suppliers	Process customer orders and handle personal data on behalf of SHOT Café as third-party data processors.	Must comply with SHOT Café's data standards and UAE PDPL. SHOT Café remains responsible for ensuring vendors handle data ethically.	It is unclear whether data sharing agreements with these platforms meet PDPL requirements for lawful third-party processing.
UAE Data Office & TDRA	Regulators	Oversee compliance with Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 (UAE PDPL) and issue guidance on	Set the legal boundaries within which SHOT Café must operate. Non-compliance can result in	SHOT Café's current data practices may not fully satisfy regulatory requirements around

		data protection standards.	finances and reputational damage.	consent and transparency.
SHOT Café Founders / Shareholders	Owners	Set the overall direction and values of the organization, including commitment to ethical and sustainable operations.	Responsible for ensuring the business model does not prioritize data-driven profit over customer rights and trust.	Long-term business sustainability depends on embedding ethical data practices into the company's core strategy.
Social Media Followers (Instagram)	End Users	Engage with SHOT Café content through likes, comments, and direct messages, generating behavioral data on third-party platforms.	Users interacting via Instagram are subject to Meta's data policies, which SHOT Café has limited control over.	SHOT Café should disclose that interactions on external platforms are governed by third-party privacy policies.

8 Adaptive and AI Systems

8.1 Use of Adaptive AI Systems

The digital platforms of today rely on adaptive AI systems because these systems provide users with customized experiences that utilize data for their interactions. The systems create customized recommendations by analyzing user data together with their individual preferences and historical activities which leads to better user experiences and improved decision-making capabilities (Masciari et al., 2024). The technologies operate in SHOT Café through their implementation on third-party platforms which include social media channels and delivery applications that use algorithms to recommend products and special offers and content based on user behavior.

The company utilizes its AI systems to enhance its recommendation capabilities through their work with active users who provide ongoing feedback which results in higher customer engagement and superior customer targeting methods (Kaponis & Maragoudakis, 2022). Digital platforms use recommendation algorithms to direct consumer behavior by showcasing specific products and their associated prices. Digital marketing utilizes AI-powered solutions such as chatbots and targeted advertising systems which automate customer interactions while delivering personalized content to users (Kaponis & Maragoudakis, 2022). The organization experiences increased operational efficiency through new technologies but this also creates greater reliance on machines for decision making and the need for continuous data acquisition.

8.2 Ethical Implications of AI

Adaptive AI systems create various ethical challenges which exist alongside their operational advantages. The field of algorithmic bias presents a major challenge because AI systems develop biased results when they learn from incomplete or unbalanced datasets (Mensah, 2023). The existence of "black box" AI systems prevents users from understanding how those systems make decisions which results in decreased user trust and system transparency (Masciari et al. 2024 Mirbabaie et al. 2022).

The ability to manipulate how users behave represents a major issue that needs to be addressed. Recommendation systems create user experiences which lead to higher user engagement because they have the power to control user choices through their design which first serves business goals and then user freedom (Masciari et al., 2024). Organizations face ethical challenges about whether they should control consumer behavior because the system creates solutions which disadvantage particular groups. The development of AI systems requires organizations to gather extensive data which creates major privacy threats because their ongoing data collection makes them more vulnerable to unauthorized access and data breaches (Kaponis & Maragoudakis, 2022).

The question of who should take responsibility for AI systems that produce dangerous results remains unsolved because it proves challenging to establish fault boundaries (Mensah, 2023). SHOT Café needs to establish transparent and just AI systems that operate with ethical principles throughout its digital system because these requirements currently present operational difficulties.

9 Computer Forensics

9.1 Use of Computer Forensics

By making it possible to look into data breaches, fraud, and illegal access, computer forensics is essential to maintaining the security and integrity of digital systems. The SHOT Café uses digital platforms which include online ordering systems and third-party applications to handle customer data. Forensic techniques enable businesses to track unauthorized activities through their systems. The techniques of digital forensics enable businesses to monitor cybersecurity threats through their systems while tracking digital events to find security breaches (Broséus et al., 2016).

The second element of digital forensic techniques involves methodical gathering and examination of electronic evidence, which encompasses all communication data and login records and transaction logs. Artificial intelligence serves as a modern technological solution to enhance this process by detecting unusual patterns and authenticating digital content (Maras & Alexandrou, 2018). Organizations like SHOT Café can reduce threats to client data by strengthening their security infrastructure and proactively detecting fraud or unauthorized access through the integration of forensic capabilities inside information systems (Kaponis & Maragoudakis, 2022).

9.2 Use of digital trails

Digital footprints, which people also refer to as digital traces, exist as users work with digital systems. SHOT Café tracks its operations through customer order records and website access logs and social media interaction data. User-generated content together with system logs automatically capture system activity data for complete system activity documentation (Kaponis & Maragoudakis, 2022).

Digital trails function as essential tools that help businesses track customer movements and demonstrate their operational integrity. Organizations can monitor system activity through statistical analysis while detecting any unusual patterns that might lead to policy breaches or legal violations. Digital trails enable companies to conduct continuous audits through their comprehensive data tracking system which also supports ethical monitoring practices (Etzioni & Etzioni, 2016). The extensive tracking of user activities creates privacy concerns together with surveillance difficulties which require organizations to implement responsible and limited usage of their monitoring tools (Wiener et al., 2023).

10 Sustainability Policy

10.1 Social Responsibility Policy

SHOT Café's sustainability approach must prioritize social responsibility by ensuring that its digital systems operate in an ethical and user-centered manner. This includes embedding ethical considerations such as fairness, transparency, and respect for user privacy into the design and use of its information systems. Organizations are increasingly expected to adopt value-based system design approaches that prioritize user well-being and community trust rather than purely operational efficiency (Spiekermann et al., 2022).

SHOT Café must stop all of its digital platforms, including social media websites and third-party apps, from employing design strategies that change user behavior and steal personal data for profit. The company must implement open data handling practices that enable people to control their personal data and understand how it will be used. Digital interactions require user well-being to be prioritized because excessive notification systems and targeted marketing result in digital fatigue problems. SHOT Café can maintain its positive brand reputation while building customer trust through its use of ethical data handling methods.

10.2 Sustainability in IT Governance

Sustainable IT governance aims to establish digital systems that operate with high efficiency and maintain responsible operations while achieving environmental sustainability goals. SHOT Café operates digital platforms which create environmental impacts and energy consumption despite its absence of large data center operations. Organizations must implement efficient data management solutions which include reducing unnecessary data storage and achieving maximum system performance.

The current approaches to attaining sustainable IT operations necessitate the reduction of waste produced by digital systems as well as resource optimization to improve energy efficiency (Fatima & Ehsan, 2023). Organizations should track system performance metrics while implementing procedures that will decrease resource usage over time. The proper IT resource lifecycle management, which includes hardware recycling and disposal, contributes to environmental sustainability goals. SHOT Café can establish efficient service delivery through its operational procedures which will enable the business to achieve its digital sustainability goals.

10.3 Sustainable Procurement Policy

SHOT Café needs to implement sustainability practices during its interactions with third-party service providers which include delivery platforms and digital service vendors. Sustainable procurement involves selecting partners who adhere to ethical, environmental, and legal standards in their operations. Organizations now need to assess their suppliers based on two criteria which include the suppliers' sustainable practices and their methods of managing sensitive data (Fiorini & Jabbour, 2017).

SHOT Café needs to confirm that all external platforms handling customer information follow both appropriate ethical standards and existing data protection regulations. The organization must establish requirements for data transparency while enforcing secure data protection processes and avoiding any business relationships with vendors who operate through unethical or environmentally damaging practices. Organizations can track their partners' sustainability compliance through the transparent supply chain system which maintains visibility of their operations (Zeng et al., 2020).

Through its sustainable procurement strategy SHOT Café can decrease third-party data management risks while promoting ethical business practices and environmental sustainability across its entire operations.

11 Final Ethics and Sustainability Policy

11.1 Policy Objective

- Ensure ethical, transparent, and sustainable management of customer data across all digital platforms
- Align organizational practices with the **UAE Personal Data Protection Law (PDPL)**
- Build and maintain long-term customer trust

11.2 Core Principles

- **Transparency:** Clearly inform users about data collection, usage, and sharing practices
- **Privacy Protection:** Safeguard personal data from unauthorized access and misuse
- **Fairness:** Ensure data-driven decisions do not result in bias or discrimination
- **Accountability:** Assign responsibility for ethical data practices across all organizational levels

11.3 Data Management Commitments

- Collect only necessary data based on clear and legitimate purposes
- Obtain explicit user consent before processing personal data
- Ensure secure storage and controlled access to all customer information
- Limit data sharing with third parties to compliant and authorized partners only

11.4 AI and Digital Systems Responsibility

- Ensure AI systems used in marketing and customer interaction remain transparent and fair
- Avoid manipulation of user behavior through excessive personalization or targeting
- Regularly review algorithms to minimize bias and ensure ethical outcomes

11.5 Sustainability Commitments

- Optimize digital systems to reduce unnecessary data storage and energy consumption
- Promote responsible use of IT resources and proper lifecycle management
- Partner only with vendors that follow ethical and sustainable practices

11.6 Governance and Accountability

- Establish clear roles for management, IT teams, and third-party partners
- Ensure leadership oversight of all data-related decisions
- Maintain compliance with legal and regulatory frameworks

11.7 Monitoring and Continuous Improvement

- Conduct regular audits of data practices and system performance
- Use digital tracking and logs to ensure accountability and traceability
- Continuously update policies based on evolving regulations and technologies

12 Conclusion

The research has conducted a complete examination of the ethical and legal as well as sustainability problems that arise from data handling activities in SHOT Café's digital environment. The research discovered that three main ethical problems emerge from data collection activities which lack clear disclosure processes and user permission requirements and allow third-party access to collected data. Companies now have more responsibilities to preserve customer data in ways that uphold user privacy rights and foster relationships based on trust. A comprehensive foundation for resolving these specific issues is created by the creation of an organized, moral, and sustainable policy framework.

The establishment of an organized and ethical and sustainable policy framework delivers an extensive solution which addresses particular problems. SHOT Café establishes responsible data governance through its alignment of data operations with UAE Personal Data Protection Law (PDPL) requirements and its implementation of ethical principles which include fairness and accountability and openness. The organization enhances its risk management abilities and compliance requirements through its stakeholder approach which includes adaptive AI systems and digital forensics.

Companies need to assume greater responsibility for their digital operations because sustainable practices require them to do so especially in the areas of IT governance and procurement. SHOT Café can achieve sustainable business growth while increasing customer

trust and meeting regulatory requirements through its implementation of sustainable methods and ethical data practices.

The study shows that in order to accomplish successful data management, firms must strike a balance between sustainability standards, legal obligations, and ethical considerations. The restaurant business must continue to monitor SHOT Café operations and create regulations due to new regulatory constraints and continuous technological advancements.

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